

4Prep — Data Researcher

What data we need for each university

Your job

For each US university, find the information in the tables below and write it into our spreadsheet — **together with the link of the official university page where you found it.**

The most important rule: never guess a number. Do not estimate, do not round, do not calculate, do not copy from Google or ChatGPT. Only write what is printed on the university's own website.

If you cannot find something — that is **fine and normal**. Leave the answer empty and instead write two things: *why it is missing* and *who the student should ask*. This is a finished, correct answer. An invented number is not.

Part 1 — Money and dates (11 items)

#	What to find	Where to look on the website	Example of a good answer
1	Tuition — price of study for one year, for an international student	"Cost of Attendance" / "Tuition and Fees" / Student Accounts page	\$62,226 / year (2026-27)
2	Mandatory fees — extra required fees, separate from tuition	Same page as tuition	\$6,216 / year (2026-27)
3	Housing and food — cost of living on campus for one year	Cost of Attendance	\$14,250 housing + \$8,942 food / year (2026-27)
4	Total cost per year — the total the university itself prints. Never add the numbers yourself.	Cost of Attendance	\$94,624 / year (2026-27)
5	Application fee — and whether a waiver (free application) exists	"Apply" / "First-Year Applicants"	\$90 one time; fee waiver available
6	Application deadline for international first-year students	"Apply" / "Deadlines"	Regular Decision: January 1
7	Start terms — when an international student can begin	"Apply" / International Admissions	Fall, spring and summer entry
8	Language of study and whether an English test is required	International Admissions	English; an English test is required if schooling was not in English

9	Financial aid for international students — do they give it, and on what basis? Copy their own words. Do not write an amount here.	Financial Aid / International	Need-blind; the university meets 100% of demonstrated need for international students
10	SAT / ACT policy — required, optional, or not accepted — and for which entry year	"Standardized Testing"	Test optional for fall 2027 entry; SAT or ACT required from fall 2028
11	Visa money proof (I-20 amount) — how much money the student must show for the F-1 visa	International Student Services / "Financial Requirements for International Students"	\$22,980 for a first-year self-sponsored F-1 student

Part 2 — Entry requirements (6 items)

For each of these, write the minimum score the university publishes — or write that they publish no minimum — or mark it as missing.

#	What to find	Example of a good answer
12	IELTS minimum	Minimum IELTS 6.5 required
13	TOEFL minimum	Minimum TOEFL iBT 79 required
14	Duolingo minimum	Duolingo accepted, minimum 105
15	SAT expectation	Required; no minimum score is published
16	ACT expectation	Required; no minimum score is published
17	GPA minimum	Minimum 2.5 GPA on a 4.0 scale

Careful with wording here. "Minimum IELTS 7 required" and "our strongest applicants usually have IELTS 7" mean completely different things. Copy the sentence the university actually wrote — do not turn a typical score into a requirement.

Also: **never convert GPA** between the 4.0 scale and the 5-point scale. Write the number exactly as published.

Part 3 — Programme and scholarships

#	What to find	Where to look	Example
18	One degree programme — name, degree type, field	Official course catalogue (a real programme page, not a department page)	Computer Science, Associate of Science, Computer Science
19	At least one scholarship open to international students — exact official name and amount	Scholarships / Financial Aid / International	Illinois Wesleyan International Merit Scholarship — up to \$38,000 / year

If the university gives individual, personally-calculated aid instead of a fixed amount (Harvard, Yale, Princeton do this), then the **name** is known but the **amount** is missing. Write: "*The award is calculated individually, so no single amount is published*" and the action: "*Complete the university's financial-aid application to get a personal amount.*"

Which websites are allowed

✓ Use only these

- The university's own website
- Its admissions, international admissions, financial aid, student accounts and course catalogue pages
- Official PDF files hosted on the university's own website

✗ Never use these

- US News, Niche, BigFuture, Wikipedia, Shiksha
- YouTube, forums, agency and consultant blogs
- ChatGPT, Perplexity or any AI answer
- Google cache or archived copies

Simple test: open your link in a new browser window. If you cannot see the number on that page with your own eyes, the link is not acceptable — and the item counts as missing.

For every item, fill these columns

Column	What to write
Answer	A short sentence with the number and the academic year, exactly as published — e.g. \$62,226 / year (2026-27)
Link	The exact page where you saw it. Not the homepage.
Date checked	The date you opened the page.
Saved copy	Save the page as a PDF and keep it in the university's folder.

If the item is missing, leave the three columns above empty and fill these two instead:

Column	What to write
Why it is missing	Say what you checked. <i>"Yale does not publish a single visa financial-proof amount on its admissions or cost pages."</i> Do not write "N/A", "not found" or "no information".
Who to ask	Name a real office. <i>"Ask Yale's Office of International Students and Scholars for the amount required."</i> Do not write "contact the university".

Never leave a cell fully empty. Every one of the 17 items must have either an answer with a link, or a reason plus an office to ask. Nothing in between.

Before you send the work — check these

- All 17 items are answered or marked as missing. None left blank.
- Every answer has a working link, and the number is visible on that page.
- Every missing item has both a reason and an office to ask.
- All money is in US dollars. Nothing converted to som.
- No number was calculated or rounded by you.
- The academic year is written wherever the university writes it.
- A saved PDF exists for every link.
- No third-party website appears anywhere in the file.

Why this matters: a 17-year-old student in Tashkent may decide where to spend \$20,000 based on the number you write. One wrong number breaks the trust of the whole product. A missing number, written honestly, does not.